



WAR PATH

TOY SOLDIERS displayed by a hawker outside the Taj Mahal Hotel, one of the four places in Mumbai that terrorists struck on November 26, 2008, are a street-smart tribute to the securitymen who brought the nightmare to an end.

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Amid a slew of allegations of corruption and misuse of state machinery to further her interests, Mayawati has reaped some praise. On a visit to the state capital on November 16, Nandan Nilekani, chief of the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) and former Infosys chairman, surprised many by commending the chief minister's efforts to implement the unique identity number project. The card will carry a unique number, photograph and biometric data of every Indian citizen. Nilekani was on a visit to assess the project's progress in the state. Earlier, Home Minister P. Chidambaram had also praised the Mayawati administration for implementing a new selection process for 31,000 constables. While the Congress high command may be critical of her, it seems that Sonia Gandhi's representatives appreciate at least some of Mayawati's deeds.

by Subhash Mishra

**MAYAWATI HAS
COME IN FOR
PRAISE FROM
NILEKANI OVER
THE UNIQUE
IDENTITY
NUMBER
PROJECT IN
UTTAR
PRADESH.**

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